

CYBERVERSE

The Complete Game Manual

Every click has consequences.

CyberVerse is a cinematic cybersecurity survival game built for Team Midnight Builders. The player takes on the role of a field agent for India's Cyber Crime Cell, investigating real scam patterns — OTP fraud, digital arrest scams, phishing, vishing, and more — by walking into a scene, picking up an in-world phone, and inspecting the evidence themselves before a countdown forces a decision. This manual documents every system, character, level, and screen in the game.

1. Meet the Characters

Character	Role	Who they are
ARIA	AI Cyber-Defense Unit	Built by India's Cyber Crime Cell to fight fraud at the speed it happens. ARIA analyzes every scam with the player in real time and debriefs them after each case — she is the reason a wrong call isn't the end of the story. She narrates the opening briefing and every post-case Mentor Debrief.
The Puppeteer	Unknown — mastermind behind the attack wave	Nobody has seen his face. He doesn't break into systems — he breaks into trust. Every scam in the city, from a fake SMS to a fake arrest, traces back to his network. He appears in the opening cinematic and is the named antagonist behind the game-over state ("The Puppeteer wins this round").

Both characters are introduced to the player directly in-game, on a dedicated "Know who you're dealing with" screen shown right after the opening cinematic and before character creation.

2. Choosing a Role — What Each One Actually Does

At character creation, the player picks one of three roles. This is not cosmetic — each role changes the player's starting stats for the entire playthrough, giving a genuine strategic reason to pick one over another.

Role	Starting edge	Best for
Field Agent	Starts with 130 Health instead of the default 100.	Players who want a safety margin — you can absorb one or two more wrong calls before it's game over.
Code Breaker	Starts with 700 Cyber IQ instead of the default 300.	Players who want to lean on ARIA's hints early — at 40 IQ per hint, that's up to 17 hints banked from the start instead of 7.
Signal Analyst	Starts at 0 Stress instead of the default 20.	Players who want breathing room — since the case timer is calculated from Stress, this role gets the longest possible timer on every case until mistakes raise Stress.

The role's effect is shown live on the character-creation screen as a one-line tagline under the selected avatar, so the player never has to guess what they're picking.

3. The Four Pillars System

Four stats are visible in the HUD at all times. None of them are decorative — each one changes what actually happens in the game.

Pillar	Rises when...	Falls when...	What it actually controls
Trust	A case is resolved correctly.	A case is resolved incorrectly, or the timer runs out.	Tints the ambient particle field, floor grid, and city lighting across the whole game — the world visibly gets colder and redder as Trust drops.
Cyber IQ	A case is resolved correctly (+40).	Never falls — it is spent, not lost.	A currency. Spending 40 IQ during an investigation instantly reveals one unfound clue via the "Ask ARIA for a hint" button.
Health	Never rises during play (only resets on retry).	A case is resolved incorrectly (-15, or -25 if the timer expired).	A real fail-state. Reaching 0 triggers the Game Over screen ("The Puppeteer wins this round"), forcing a retry of the case.
Stress	A case is resolved incorrectly (+15, or +25 on timeout).	Never falls on its own during a playthrough.	Directly shortens the countdown timer on every subsequent case — the formula runs from 36 seconds at 0 Stress down to 18 seconds at 100 Stress.

4. The Core Gameplay Loop

Every one of the 10 cases follows the same investigate-then-act structure:

- 1. Select a case** — From the case dashboard — all 10 are unlocked from the start, so any case can be played in any order.
- 2. Mission briefing** — ARIA introduces the scene and the person at the center of it before the player enters.
- 3. Enter the scene** — A location renders with its own atmosphere (rain, metro light-streaks, market dust) and accent color.
- 4. Wake the phone** — A draggable 3D phone sits in the scene. The player rotates it, then taps to wake it.
- 5. Open the relevant app** — Messages, a call transcript, email, or the QR scanner — whichever the scam uses.
- 6. Investigate** — The player taps the underlined, suspicious parts of the content themselves. Each tap adds a clue to the Evidence Tray. Nothing is solved for them.
- 7. Act under the clock** — Once at least one clue is found, three action choices unlock. A visible radial clock beside the phone counts down — its length is set by the player's current Stress.
- 8. Consequence** — The chosen action plays out with a written outcome and an immediate Trust/Health/Stress update, plus a synthesized success or failure chime.

9. ARIA's Mentor Debrief — A click-to-expand explainer: why the scam worked, the warning signs, what to do immediately, recovery steps, and the real 1930 helpline / cybercrime.gov.in portal.

10. Spot the Fake — A short applied-recognition exercise — a real vs. fake message or domain, side by side — testing whether the lesson actually landed.

5. UI Components Glossary

Component	What it does
Case Dashboard	The hub screen — a grid of thumbnail cards, one per case, each showing its icon, category tag, and a one-line hook. All 10 are unlocked immediately.
3D Phone	The central investigation device. Freely draggable to rotate before it wakes; every case's evidence lives inside it.
Scene Clock	A radial countdown rendered beside the phone once an app is open, showing seconds remaining and pulsing red under 30% time left.
Evidence Tray	A row of chips that fills up as the player taps suspicious content — a visible record of what's been found so far.
Hint Button	Spends 40 Cyber IQ to instantly reveal one unfound clue. Disabled if IQ is too low or every clue is already found.
Trust Ring	A circular dial on the dashboard and reward screens showing current Trust, colored cyan / saffron / crimson by band.
Mentor Debrief	ARIA's post-case explainer, broken into four click-to-expand sections plus the real Indian helpline and reporting portal.
Spot the Fake	A two-option recognition test at the end of every case, with immediate right/wrong feedback.
Mute toggle	Top-right icon button, mutes/unmutes the generative soundtrack at any time.

6. The Audio System

All sound in CyberVerse is generated live with Tone.js — there are no audio files. This lets the score react instantly to what's happening in the game.

- **Mood per case** — the ambient pad transposes into a different key and filter brightness keyed to each chapter's accent color, so a phishing-email case and a digital-arrest case are sonically distinct.
- **Tension shift** — the filter brightens sharply whenever the Scene Clock drops below 30% remaining, then relaxes back once the danger passes.
- **Success / failure chimes** — a short ascending arpeggio plays on a correct decision; a short descending tone plays on an incorrect one, reinforcing the outcome instantly.

7. The 10 Cases

Every case is a distinct, real scam pattern active in India today.

#	Case title	Crime category	Phone app used	Location
01	The Rs. 2 Lakh SMS	OTP fraud	Messages	Priya's apartment
02	The Hacked Friend	Social fraud	WhatsApp	Line 3 Metro
03	The Rs. 500 Cashback QR	QR / UPI fraud	QR Scanner	Sarojini Market
04	The Digital Arrest	Video call scam	Video call	Home office
05	The Rs. 48,760 Refund	Phishing email	Mail	Office desk
06	The Fake Support Call	Vishing	Phone call	Living room
07	The Login From Lagos	Instagram takeover	Instagram	Hostel room
08	Rs. 3,000/Day, No Interview	Job fraud	Telegram	Café corner table
09	Loan Approved. Pay Us First.	Loan app scam	QuickCash Loan chat	Rented flat
10	The Free SIM Upgrade	SIM swap	Phone call	Bus stop

An 11th slot on the dashboard is shown locked, labeled "More cases incoming," listing deepfake voice/video, crypto fraud, courier scams, and Aadhaar/PAN KYC scams as the next planned additions.

8. Real Reporting Resources Built Into the Game

Every Mentor Debrief ends with the same two real, verified Indian resources — not fictional ones — so the educational payoff extends beyond the game itself:

- **1930** — India's National Cyber Crime Helpline.
 - **cybercrime.gov.in** — the National Cyber Crime Reporting Portal.
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